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UPSC

History

Prelims

Mahajanapadas

With PYQ's



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Mahajanapadas

Emergence of the Mahajanapadas

Historical Background

- **Timeframe:** Around **6th century BCE**.
- **Context:** Transition from tribal Vedic society to organized territorial states.
- Marked the beginning of **Second Urbanisation** in the Indian subcontinent.
- Political landscape transformed from **Jana-based kinship groups** to **territorial units**.

Causes of Emergence

Factor	Role in Emergence
Iron Technology	Use of iron tools (e.g., ploughshares) enabled forest clearance and intensive agriculture; iron weapons enhanced warfare capabilities.
Agricultural Surplus	Led to settled agrarian communities and the rise of urban centres.
Permanent Settlements	From Vedic tribal (jana) affiliations to territorial identity (janapada) .
Political Organisation	Transition from tribal assemblies to centralized rule under kings or oligarchic republics.
Economic Growth	Growth in trade, craft production, and surplus led to emergence of cities and taxation systems.
Social Stratification	Rise of warrior (Kshatriya) class; rigidifying of varna system.

Janapadas to Mahajanapadas

- **Janapada:** Early territorial state (~1000–600 BCE), derived from “Jana” (tribe) + “Pada” (foot/settlement).
- **Mahajanapada:** Larger and more powerful territorial states that evolved from Janapadas around **600 BCE**.
- **Transition:** Due to territorial expansion, military strength, economic control, and fortified capitals.

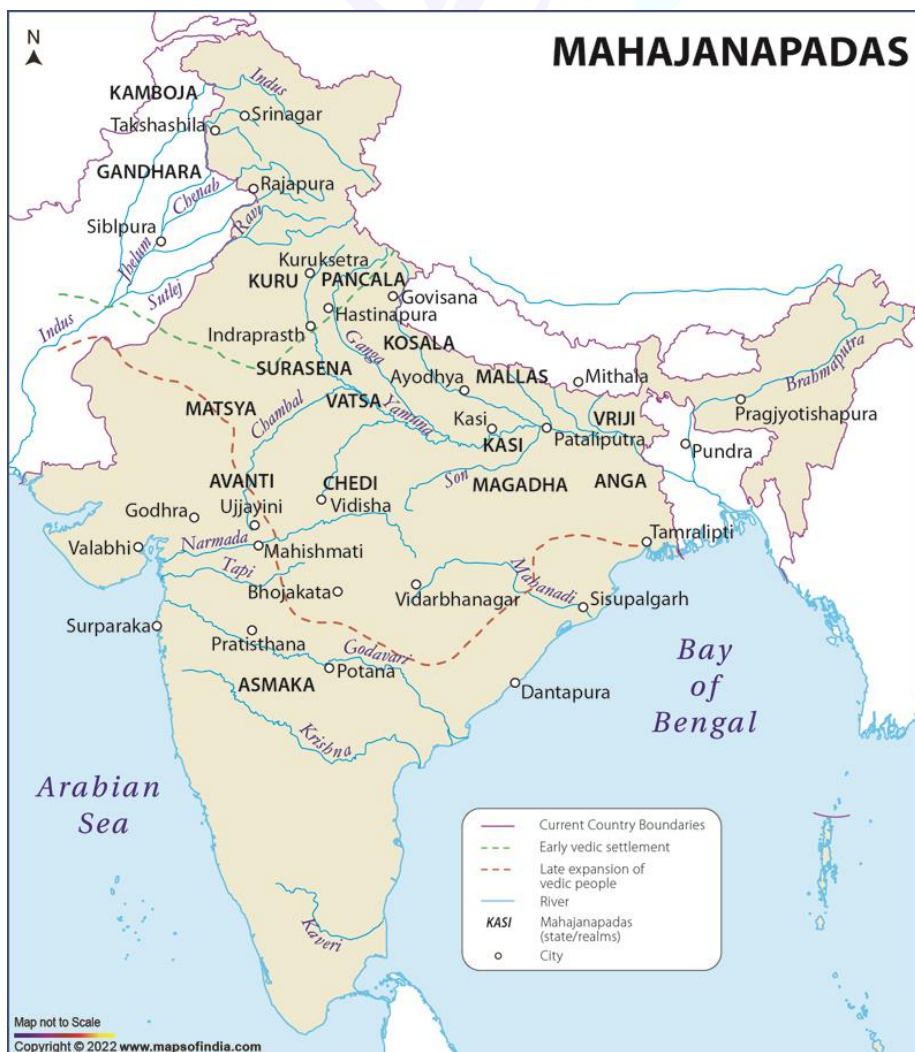


Nature of Mahajanapadas

Feature	Description
Political Structure	Either monarchies (rajyas) or republics (ganas/sanghas) .
Governance in Republics	Ruled by Kshatriya clans , often termed oligarchies (e.g., Mallas, Licchavis).
Fortified Capitals	Most Mahajanapadas had walled cities indicating urban planning and administrative centres.
Military Organisation	Standing armies supported by revenue from agricultural surplus and trade.

Cultural & Religious Changes

- **Religious Movements:** Rise of **Buddhism and Jainism** as reactions to ritualism and inequality.
- **Intellectual Growth:** Flourishing of **Upanishadic philosophy**, early science, and logic.
- **Urban Culture:** Expansion of cities, education centres (e.g., Taxila), trade guilds, and crafts.



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List of 16 Mahajanapadas

Mahajanapada	Capital	Modern Location	Rivers Flowing in the Region	Description
Anga	Champa	Munger & Bhagalpur (Bihar)	Chandan (Champa)	Important commercial centre; merchants sailed to Suvarnabhumi; annexed by Bimbisara of Magadha.
Magadha	Rajgriha / Pataliputra	Nalanda, Gaya, Patna (Bihar)	Ganga, Son	Ruled by Haryanka dynasty; emerged as a powerful empire; centre of early Jainism and Buddhism.
Kashi	Varanasi	Varanasi (U.P.)	Ganga	Incorporated into Kosala by King Kansa; famous for cotton textiles and crafts.
Kosala	Shravasti / Kushavati	Eastern U.P. (Ayodhya region)	Sarayu (Ghaghara)	Ruled by King Prasenjit; Buddha's contemporary; includes Shakya tribe (Lumbini).
Vajji	Vaishali	Vaishali (North Bihar)	Gandak	Confederacy of Lichchavis and others; Mahavira belonged to the Jnatikas; early republican polity.
Malla	Kushinara and Pava	Kushinagar (U.P.)	Rapti, Gandak	Buddha took last meal at Pava and attained Mahaparinirvana



				at Kushinara.
Vatsa	Kaushambi	Prayagraj (U.P.)	Ganga, Yamuna	Ruled by Udayana; famous for fine cotton textiles; culturally advanced.
Kuru	Indraprastha	Meerut (Western U.P.)	Yamuna, Ganga	Known from Mahabharata; early centre of Vedic culture.
Panchala	Ahichchhatra / Kampilya	Bareilly & Farrukhabad (U.P.)	Ganga, Yamuna	Northern (Ahichchhatra) & Southern (Kampilya); center of education and Vedic culture.
Matsya	Viratanagara	Jaipur, Alwar (Rajasthan)	Chambal	Ruled by King Virata; allied with Pandavas.
Shurasena	Mathura	Mathura (U.P.)	Yamuna	Ruled by Avantipura; disciple of Buddha; important centre for Krishna worship.
Avanti	Ujjain / Mahishmati	Malwa (M.P.)	Shipra, Narmada	Divided into North and South; ruled by King Pradyota; rival to Magadha.
Chedi	Shuktimati	Bundelkhand (M.P./U.P.)	Ken, Yamuna	Ruled by Shishupala; located between Yamuna and Narmada.
Asmaka (Assaka)	Potali / Paithan	Nizamabad, Telangana / Godavari	Godavari	Only southern Mahajanapada; mentioned in



		basin		Buddhist texts.
Gandhara	Taxila	North-West Pakistan / Afghanistan	Indus, Kabul	Major trade and learning centre; mentioned in Achaemenid inscriptions.
Kamboja	Rajapura / Pooncha	Kashmir & NW Frontier Province	Beas (Vipas), Indus tributaries	Famous for horse-breeding and cavalry; part of Uttarapatha.

Sources of Information

Source	Relevance
Buddhist Texts	<i>Anguttara Nikaya</i> – mentions 16 Mahajanapadas.
Jain Texts	<i>Bhagavati Sutra</i> – mentions some Mahajanapadas (e.g., Vanga, Malaya).
Sanskrit Epics	<i>Mahabharata, Ramayana</i> – mention many Janapadas and early kingdoms.
Puranas	Provide genealogies and details of dynasties.
Archaeological Evidence	Fortifications, coinage, pottery, urban remains.

Significance in Indian History

- **Foundations of Empire:** Set stage for **Mauryan Empire**.
- **Territorial Identity:** Shift from tribal to land-based identity.
- **Political Centralisation:** Emergence of formal states with administrative structures.
- **Urbanisation & Economy:** Consolidated the agrarian economy and trade networks.

Features of Mahajanapadas

General Overview

- **Time period:** 6th century BCE
- **Number:** 16 Mahajanapadas
- **Geographical spread:** Across northern, eastern, and central India
- **Significance:** Marked the transition from tribal societies to territorial kingdoms and oligarchic republics



Political Structure

A. Kingdoms (Monarchical States)

- **Centralized authority:** King was the sovereign with all power
- **Hereditary monarchy:** Mostly followed **primogeniture**
- **Dynastic rule:** Example – Magadha under Haryanka dynasty
- **Administration:**
 - Ministers (Mantrin), Commander-in-chief (Senanayaka)
 - Officials like Amatyas, Mahamatras, Ayuktas
- **Decline of popular assemblies:** Sabha and Samiti replaced by Parishad (Brahmana advisory body)

B. Gana-Sanghas (Oligarchic Republics)

- **Collective rule:** Assembly (Santhagara) of Kshatriya clan heads
- **Titles:** Chief called Ganapati or Gananaraja
- **Voting:** Issues decided by consensus or vote (using **salakas**); vote collected by **Salaka-gahapaka**
- **Location:** Mostly in Himalayan foothills (e.g., Vajji, Malla)
- **Tolerance:** Promoted heterodox sects like Buddhism and Jainism
- **Classes:** Only two major strata – ruling Kshatriyas and Dasa-Karmakaras (servants/labourers)

Administration

- **Village** was the basic unit (Grama); 2 villages formed a Sangrama
- **Leaders:** Gamini/Gramika – also soldiers or animal trainers
- **Taxation system:**
 - Tax called **Bali** (collected by Balisadhakas)
 - 1/6th of agricultural produce collected by the king
 - Paid in **cash or kind**
- **Record-keeping:** Rise of writing aided tax collection

Society

- **Early caste system:** Varna system not rigid; Ksetrika and Kassaka (farmers) in Shudra jati
- **Social structure:**
 - Brahmanas, Kshatriyas, Vaishyas, Shudras
 - Shudras had no privileges; subjected to social disabilities
- **Slavery:** Widespread use of **slaves (dasa)** and **laborers (karmakaras)**



- **Kinship:**
 - Extended families (Kula)
 - Kin groups: Natakas (relatives from both parents), Natikulani

Legal System

- **Varna-based laws** (Dharmasutras): Different duties and punishments by caste
- **Royal enforcement:** Civil and criminal laws executed by royal agents
- **Punishments:** Included flogging, death penalty; often based on revenge (e.g., eye for an eye)

Economy

- **Agrarian economy:** Agriculture was the main occupation
- **Trade & commerce:**
 - Major trade routes: **Uttarapatha** and **Dakshinapatha**
 - Ports: **Tamralipta, Bharuch, Sopara**
- **Coinage:**
 - **Punch-marked coins** (kahapana, nikkha, kakanika)
 - Made of silver or copper
- **Artisan activity:** Metalworking, pottery, and city construction

Religion

- **Religious diversity:**
 - Vedic (Brahmanical) practices
 - Heterodox sects: **Buddhism, Jainism, Ajivika, Ajana, Charvaka**
- **Religious tolerance:** Gana-Sanghas more open to new ideas
 - Mahavira (Jainism) from Vajji
 - Buddha (Buddhism) from Shakya clan

Military

- **Organized armies:** Infantry, cavalry, chariots, elephants
- **Techniques:** Described in Mahabharata (e.g., Chakravyuha)
- **Standing armies:** Maintained by powerful states like Magadha

Art & Architecture

- **Structures:** Temples, palaces, stupas
- **Features:** Intricate carvings and sculptures reflecting religious themes



Important dynasties of Mahajanapada age are as follows

1. Haryanka Dynasty (Magadha)

Time Period: ~544 BCE – 413 BCE

Capital: Rajagriha (Girivraja)

Founder:

- **Bimbisara (544–492 BCE)**
 - Contemporary of **Gautama Buddha** and **Mahavira**
 - Expanded Magadha through **conquests** and **matrimonial alliances**
 - **Conquests:**
 - **Anga** (defeated Brahmadatta) – Champa became important for trade
 - **Matrimonial Alliances:**
 - **Kosala:** Married Mahakoshala (sister of Prasenjit); Kashi given as dowry
 - **Lichchhavi:** Married Chellana of Vaishali; mother of Ajatashatru
 - **Madra** (Punjab): Strengthened northern ties
 - **Diplomatic Relations:** Gandhara ruler Pukkusati sent embassy to Bimbisara
 - Patron of Buddhism and Jainism
 - Possibly **killed by his son Ajatashatru**

Ajatashatru (492–460 BCE)

- Son of Bimbisara
- Expanded through **military conquest, not matrimonial diplomacy**
- **Wars & Conquests:**
 - **Kosala:** Conflict with maternal uncle Prasenjit over Kashi
 - **Vaishali (Lichchhavis):** 16-year war; finally annexed
- **Innovations in Warfare:**
 - **Rathamusala:** Chariot with blades
 - **Mahashilakantaka:** War engine (catapult)
- **First Buddhist Council** held at **Rajagriha** after Buddha's death
- Fortified Rajagriha due to threat from **Avanti**

Udayin (Udayabhadra) (460–444 BCE)

- Son of Ajatashatru



- Founded **Pataliputra** at the confluence of Ganga and Son; shifted capital from Rajgriha
- Weak ruler; murdered possibly at the instigation of Avanti's king Palaka

2. Shishunaga Dynasty (~413 BCE – 345 BCE)

Capital(s): Vaishali (temporarily) → Pataliputra

Founder: Shishunaga

- Earlier Viceroy/Amatya of Varanasi
- Made king by **people of Magadha** after unpopular successors of Udayin
- **Major Achievements:**
 - Defeated **Avanti (Pradyota Dynasty)** – ended 100-year rivalry with Magadha
 - Unified Avanti with Magadha → strengthened Magadha's dominance
- Temporarily shifted capital to **Vaishali**

Kalashoka (Kakavarana)

- Son and successor of Shishunaga
- Shifted capital to **Pataliputra**
- Convened **Second Buddhist Council** at Vaishali (383 BCE)

3. Nanda Dynasty (345 BCE – 321 BCE)

First non-Kshatriya dynasty

Founder: Mahapadma Nanda

- Called **Ugrasena** in Pali texts; described as **Ekarat** (sole ruler)
- Known as **Sarva-Kshatrantaka** – destroyer of Kshatriyas
- Described as:
 - **Low caste origin** (Shudra mother as per Puranas)
 - **Of unknown lineage** in Buddhist texts
- **Achievements:**
 - Defeated **Kalinga**; brought image of **Jina** as victory trophy
 - Acquired **Kosala**
 - Introduced systematic **tax collection**
 - Developed **irrigation infrastructure**



- Had **largest standing army**: 2 lakh infantry, 60,000 cavalry, 6,000 elephants (as per Greek sources)

Dhanananda (Last ruler)

- Identified with **Agrammes/Xandrames** by Greek sources
- Known for:
 - **Oppression, high taxation, and arrogance**
 - Large treasury and army
- Defeated and overthrown by **Chandragupta Maurya** with help from **Chanakya (Kautilya)**

4. Maurya Dynasty (321 BCE onwards)

Founder: Chandragupta Maurya

Causes for the Rise of Magadha (Brief)

1. **Strategic Location**
 - Centrally located in the **Gangetic plain**.
 - Capitals:
 - *Rajagriha* – naturally fortified (surrounded by hills).
 - *Pataliputra* – water fort (confluence of Ganga and Son).
2. **Fertile Land**
 - Rich **alluvial soil** and good rainfall enabled **agricultural surplus**, sustaining a large army and population.
3. **Natural Resources**
 - Rich **iron deposits** (South Bihar) led to superior weapons.
 - Forests provided **timber and elephants** for warfare.
4. **Military Strength**
 - First to use **elephants extensively** in battles, giving a tactical advantage.
5. **Capable Rulers**
 - Rulers like **Bimbisara, Ajatashatru, and Mahapadma Nanda** expanded territory using war and diplomacy.
6. **Economic Growth**
 - Growth of **towns and trade** with use of **metallic coins**.
 - Revenue from **taxes and tolls** helped maintain a powerful army.
7. **Social Flexibility**
 - Less rigid society allowed openness to new **religions and ideas** (e.g., Buddhism, Jainism).



Foreign Invasions Before Maurya Dynasty

A. Persian (Iranian) Invasion

Achaemenid Empire invaded NW India due to political disunity

- **Cyrus** (558–529 BCE)
 - First to enter India, annexed **Kapisha, Gandhara, and Kamboja**
- **Darius I** (522–486 BCE)
 - Annexed **Punjab and Sindh** (~516 BCE)
 - Sent naval expedition to explore Sindhu River
 - Gandhara was the **most prosperous satrapy** – 360 talents of gold in tribute
- **Xerxes** (465–456 BCE): Indian soldiers in his army
- Persian rule lasted till **Alexander's invasion (~330 BCE)**

Effects:

- **Kharosthi script** introduced (from Aramaic)
- Boost to **Indo-Iranian trade and commerce**
- Persian influence on **Mauryan art and inscriptions** (Ashokan bell capitals, inscriptions)
- **Geographical awareness** and new **sea routes** opened

B. Greek Invasion – Alexander the Great

Time: 327–325 BCE

Entry Point: Through **Khyber Pass**

- Alexander defeated **Persians**, then entered India
- **Taxila (Ambhi)**: Submitted willingly
- **Porus (Paurava ruler)**: Fought the **Battle of Hydaspes (326 BCE)** on River Jhelum
 - Though defeated, **Porus was reinstated** as satrap by Alexander
- Alexander reached **Beas River**, but troops mutinied → forced to return
- Left India in 325 BCE → died in **Babylon** in 323 BCE

Effects:

- First **direct Indo-Greek contact**
- Greek historians (like Arrian, Strabo) gave valuable accounts of India
- Led to:



- **Introduction of coinage, guilds (Shrenis)**
- Establishment of **Indo-Greek trade routes**
- Greek influence on **art and architecture** (later seen in **Gandhara School**)
- Helped in **Mauryan rise** – destabilised NW India, easing Chandragupta's conquest

Significance of the 16 Mahajanapadas

Emergence of Territorial States

- Shift from tribal polities (*janas*) to permanent territorial kingdoms (*janapadas*).
- Led to centralized administration and statecraft.

Second Urbanization

- Major urban centers like **Rajagriha, Kaushambi, Pataliputra** emerged.
- Development of cities as hubs of **trade, culture, and governance**.

Political Alliances and Rivalries

- Frequent **alliances and conflicts** among Mahajanapadas.
- Early diplomatic practices began to evolve.

Growth of Trade and Infrastructure

- Expansion of **internal and external trade** networks.
- Construction of **roads, bridges, and caravan routes** to support commerce.

Cultural and Literary Flourishing

- Development of **early literary genres**.
- **Jataka tales, Upanishads, and Pali literature** emerged and flourished.

Religious Movements

- Birthplaces of **Buddhism and Jainism**.
- Philosophical texts like **Tripitakas** and **Jain Agamas** laid spiritual foundations.



Art and Architecture

- Early forms of **stupa architecture** began (e.g., relic stupas).
- Influenced later Buddhist and Jain architectural styles.

Legacy in Indian History

- Innovations in **administration, economy, and religion** influenced Mauryan Empire and beyond.
- Created a political and cultural groundwork for classical Indian civilization.

Conclusion

The Mahajanapadas marked a crucial phase in ancient Indian history, transitioning from tribal units to organized territorial states. They laid the foundation for urbanization, political centralization, and the rise of new religions like Buddhism and Jainism. Among them, Magadha emerged as the most powerful, setting the stage for future imperial expansions.



Mahajanapadas PYQ's : (without Answers for Practice)

1. With reference to ancient India (600–322 BC), consider the following pairs:

Territorial Region	River flowing in the region
I. Asmaka	Godavari
II. Kamboja	Vipasa
III. Avanti	Mahanadi
IV. Kosala	Sarayu

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- (a) Only one UPSC CSE 2025
 (b) Only two
 (c) Only three
 (d) All the four

2. In which one of the following regions was Dhanyakataka, which flourished as a prominent Buddhist centre under the Mahasanghikas, located?

- (a) Andhra UPSC IAS (Pre) 2023
 (b) Gandhara
 (c) Kalinga
 (d) Magadha

3. Between which of the following rivers was the ancient town of Takshashila located?

UPSC CSE 2006

- (a) Indus and Jhelum

- (b) Jhelum and Chenab
 (c) Chenab and Ravi
 (d) Ravi and Beas

4. Which one among the followings was not contemporary to three others?

- (a) Bimbisara UPSC CSE 2005
 (b) Gautam Buddha
 (c) Menander (Milind)
 (d) Prasenjit

5. With reference to the invaders in ancient India which one of the following is the correct chronological order?

UPSC CSE 2000

- (a) Greeks-Sakas-Kushans
 (b) Greeks-Kushans-Sakas
 (c) Sakas-Greeks-Kushans
 (d) Sakas-Kushans-Greeks

6. Which one of the following dynasties was ruling over North India at the time of Alexander's invasion?

UPSC CSE 2000

- (a) Nanda
 (b) Maurya
 (c) Sunga
 (d) Kanva

7. Which one of the following was initially the most powerful city of India in the 6th century B.C.?

UPSC CSE 1999

- (a) Gandhar
 (b) Kamboj
 (c) Kashi
 (d) Magadha



8. The Indo-Greek kingdom set up in north Afghanistan in the beginning of the second century BC was:

- (a) Bactria **UPSC CSE 1999**
- (b) Scythia
- (c) Zedrasia
- (d) Aria

9. From the third century AD when the Huna invasion ended the Roman Empire, the Indian merchants relied more and more on the:

- (a) African trade **UPSC CSE 1999**
- (b) West-European trade
- (c) South-East Asian trade
- (d) Middle-Eastern trade

10. The following map shows four of the sixteen Mahajanapadas that existed in ancient India. The places marked A, B, C and D respectively are:

UPSC 1997

- (a) Matsya, Cedi, Kosala, Anga
- (b) Surasena, Avanti, Vatsa, Magadha
- (c) Matsya, Avanti, Vatsa, Anga
- (d) Surasena, Cedi, Kosala, Magadha

11. Which one of the following statements about ancient Indian Mahajanapadas is correct?

CDS I 2014

- (a) All Mahajanapadas were

oligarchies where power was exercised by a group of people
(b) All Mahajanapadas were located in Eastern India

- (c) No army was maintained by the Mahajanapadas
- (d) Buddhist and Jaina texts list sixteen Mahajanapadas

12. From among the following Mahajanapadas identify the gana/sangha (oligarchy)

CDS I 2022

- (A) Magadha
- (B) Vajji
- (C) Avanti
- (D) Kosala

13. Which one of the following is NOT listed as one of the sixteen mahajana-padas in the pre-Mauryan period?

CAPF 2020

- (a) Kuru
- (b) Vatsa
- (c) Gandhara
- (d) Kalinga

14. Anguttara Nikaya is the earliest text which mentions the list of 16 Mahajanapadas. Which among the following texts also gives the list of 16 Mahajanapadas?

Manipur PSC (Pre) 2023

- (A) Kalpa Sutra
- (B) Dipavamsa
- (C) Bhagwati Sutra



(D) Mahavastu

Options:

- (a) Only (A) and (B)
- (b) Only (C) and (D)
- (c) Only (A), (B), (C) and (D)
- (d) Only (A), (C) and (D)

15. Match the following:

MH PSC (Pre) 2022

Mahajanapada | King

- (a) Kashi | (i) Bimbisara
- (b) Kosal | (ii) Ashwasena
- (c) Magadha | (iii) Udayan
- (d) Vatsa | (iv) Prasenjit

Options:

- (a) (iii) (i) (iv) (ii)
- (b) (ii) (iv) (i) (iii)
- (c) (i) (iii) (iv) (ii)
- (d) (iv) (iii) (ii) (i)

16. Match the following:

Maharashtra PSC 2022

Mahajanapada | King

- A. Kashi | 1. Bimbisara
- B. Kosal | 2. Ashwasena
- C. Magadha | 3. Udayan
- D. Vatsa | 4. Prasenjit

Options:

- (a) 3 1 4 2
- (b) 2 4 1 3
- (c) 1 3 4 2
- (d) 4 3 2 1

17. 'Mandhata' was the ancient name of which pilgrimage centre?

- (a) Kamadgiri **MPPSC Pre 2022**
- (b) Omkareshwar
- (c) Amarkantak
- (d) Maheshwar

18. How many Mahajanpadas were found in the sixth century BCE India?

- (a) 16 **Mizoram PSC-2021**
- (b) 18
- (c) 20
- (d) 22

19. In which Jain literature the list of sixteen Mahajanpadas of sixth century B.C. is found?

UPPSC APO 2022

- (a) Bhagwati Sutra
- (b) Nirvavali Sutra
- (c) Vaivahik Sutra
- (d) Aupapatiya Sutra

20. Which of the following is not correctly matched?

UPPCS RO-ARO (Mains) 2016

- (a) Kamboj – Rajpur
- (b) Asmaka - Potali
- (c) Sursen - Kaushambi
- (d) Kosala - Shravasti

21. The mahajanapadas were:

Mizoram PSC (Pre) 2023

- (a) Ten Kingdoms
- (b) Twelve Kingdoms
- (c) Fifteen Kingdoms
- (d) Sixteen Kingdoms

22. Choose the correctly matched pairs of Mahajanapadas with respect to their capitals.

Mahajanapadas | Capital

- A. Avanti – Ujjainī
- B. Kosala - Kaushambi
- C. Magadha - Vaishali



D. Gandhara - Pooneh

Options: JKPSC (Pre) 2023

- (a) Only one pair matched
- (b) Only two pair matched
- (c) Only three pairs matched
- (d) All four pairs matched

23. Which of the followings pairs is not correctly matched?

Uttarakhand PCS (Mains) 2010-11

- (a) Panchala - Rohilkhand Kannauj region
- (b) Gandhara - Peshawar Rawalpindi region
- (c) Chedi - Bundelakhanda
- (d) Kuru - Himachal Pradesh

24. Champa was the capital of which Mahajanapada?

UP RO/ARO (Mains) 2014

- (a) Magadha
- (b) Vajji
- (c) Kosala
- (d) Anga

25. What was the capital of Vatsa Mahajanapada?

OPSC (OCS) Pre 2021 Paper-I

- (a) Rajghat
- (b) Kaushambi
- (c) Ujjayini
- (d) Ahichchhatra

26. Which of the following is not correctly matched?

UPPSC RO/ARO Main 2017

- (a) Anga – Champa
- (b) Kosal – Ahichchhatra/Ahichatra
- (c) Vatsa – Kaushambi
- (d) Matsya – Viratnagar

27. Chand-Pradyota was ruler of which ancient republic?

- (a) Kasi **MPPCS (Pre) 2019**
- (b) Anga
- (c) Avanti
- (d) Vajji

28. In ancient period the Northern Telangana District, Nizamabad was included in which Maha Janapada?

TPPSC Group-II Pre-Paper-I

- (a) Anga
- (b) Kuru
- (c) Asmaka
- (d) Panchala

29. Names of the 16 Mahajanapadas during Mahakarya period are mentioned in Buddhist epics. The names of which of the followings Janapadas were mentioned in Ashtadhyayi of Panini?

- A. Magadh
- B. Asmaka
- C. Kamboja
- D. Chedi
- E. Vats

Options: RAS/RTS (Pre) G.S. 2015

- (a) D & E
- (b) C, D & E
- (c) A, C, D & E
- (d) A, B & C

30. The names of 16 Mahajanapadas are mentioned in nearly in 600 BCE:

BPSC (Pre) 2003-04

- (a) Mahabharat
- (b) Ramayan



- (c) Anguttara Nikaya
(d) Lalita Vistar

- (b) 4, 1, 3, 2
(c) 3, 2, 1, 4
(d) 1, 3, 4, 2

31. Which Buddhist epics provide information about 16 Mahajanapadas during 6th century BC?

UPPCS (Pre) spl. G.S. 2004

- (a) Dirghanikaya
(b) Tripitak
(c) Deepavansha
(d) Anguttara Nikaya

32. The reference of 16 Mahajanapadas is found in which Buddhist epics?

Uttarakhand RO/ARO (Mains) G.S. 1st 2017

- (a) Anguttara Nikaya
(b) Mahavansha
(c) Dirghanikaya
(d) Mahavagga

33. Which was not among the early republics?

- (a) Shakya **UPPCS (Pre) G.S.1992**
(b) Lichchhavi
(c) Yaudheya
(d) All the above

34. Arrange the following Magadha dynasties in chronological order:

Chhattisgarh PSC (Pre) G.S.2008

1. Nanda dynasty
2. Shunga dynasty
3. Mauryan dynasty
4. Haryanka dynasty

- (a) 2, 1, 4, 3

35. Match the kings of Buddha period with their respective states and choose the correct answer from the codes given below:

UP Lower (Pre) Spl. 2004, UPPCS (Pre) GS 2000

KING (Emperor) | Kingdom (States)

- A. Pradyota | 1. Magadha
B. Udayan | 2. Vatsa
C. Prasenjita | 3. Avanti
D. Ajatashatru | 4. Koshala

Options:

- (a) 1 4 2 3
(b) 2 3 4 1
(c) 3 2 4 1
(d) 4 1 3 2

36. The city plan of ancient Shravasti is in shape:

- (a) Circular **UPPCS (Pre) G.S.2010**
(b) Crescentic
(c) Triangular
(d) Rectangular

37. In sixth century B.C. Suktimati was the capital of:

UPPCS (Mains) G.S.1st 2011

- (a) Panchal
(b) Kuru
(c) Chedi
(d) Avanti



38. The capital of North Panchal, according to Mahabharata, was located at:

UPPCS (Mains) G.S.2006

- (a) Hasthanpur
- (b) Indranarsha
- (c) Ahichatar
- (d) Mathura

39. The period of 800-600 BC is associated with which age?

BPSC (Pre) 1994

- (a) Brahmin age
- (b) Sutra period
- (c) Ramayana period
- (d) Mahabharat period

40. Janapada Located at the bank of Godavari river was:

RAS/RTS (Pre) 2008

- (a) Avanti
- (b) Vatsa
- (c) Asmaka
- (d) Kamboj

41. What was the name of Ujjain during ancient period?

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2009, MPPCS (Pre) G.S. 1993

- (a) Taxila
- (b) Avantika
- (c) Indraprastha
- (d) None of the above

42. Mathura was the capital of which of the followings during the period of 16 Mahajanapada?

Jharkhand PSC (Pre) 2013

- (a) Vajji
- (b) Vatsa

- (c) Kashi
- (d) Surasena

43. Matsya Mahajanapada of 6th century B.C. was located in:

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2017

- (a) Western Uttar Pradesh
- (b) Rajasthan
- (c) Bundelkhand
- (d) Rohilkhand

44. Match the following:

List-I (Mahajanapada) | List-II (Capital)

- A. Avanti | I. Ujjain
- B. Koshala | II. Shravasti
- C. Vatsa | III. Kaushambi
- D. Anga | IV. Champa

Options:

- (a) I II III IV
- (b) II I IV III
- (c) IV III II I
- (d) III IV I II

45. Which city served as the capital of the ancient kingdom of Magadha during the early vedic period?

- (a) Rajagriha **69th BPSC (Pre) 2023**
- (b) Campa
- (c) Vaishali
- (d) Pataliputra

46. In ancient times, the area to the south of the Ganga was known as

- (a) Takshashila **68th BPSC 2022**
- (b) Chola
- (c) Anarta



- (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

47. Who was the Physician of Magadh ruler Bimbisara?

67th BPSC (Re-exam) 2021

- (a) Vijayasena
(b) Jeevaka
(c) Manu
(d) Shilabhadra
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

48. The first capital of Magadha was—

Mizoram PSC-2021

- (a) Pataliputra
(b) Sahensa
(c) Rajgriha
(d) Taxila

49. Which of the following pairs is correctly matched?

RAS/RTS (Pre) G.S. 2013

- (a) Parshvanath-Janatrika
(b) Bindusar-Shakya
(c) Skandagupta-Maurya
(d) Chettaka-Lichelhavi

50. The remains of which ancient city have been found at the Kumrahar site?

UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 1st 2011

- (a) Vaishali
(b) Pataliputra
(c) Kapilavastu
(d) Shravasti

51. The founder of Pataliputra was:

BPSC (Pre) 2007-08

- (a) Udayin
(b) Ashoka

- (c) Bimbisara
(d) Mahapadmananda

52. Which among the following kings had settled Pataliputra city?

- (a) Shishunaga **BPSC (Pre) 2000-01**
(b) Bimbisar
(c) Ajatashatru
(d) Udayin

53. Which ruler had opted Pataliputra as his capital?

- (a) Ajatashatru **BPSC (Pre) 2003-04**
(b) Kalashoka
(c) Udayin
(d) Kanishka

54. Jivaka, the royal physician of Rajgriha, was said to be the son of a prostitute. Name of that prostitute was:

- (a) Salavati **MPPSC (Pre) G.S. 2009**
(b) Ramania
(c) Basant Sena
(d) Amrapali

55. During which century the early Magadha Empire emerged?

BPSC(Pre) 1997-98

- (a) 4th century BC
(b) 6th century BC
(c) 2nd century BC
(d) 1st century BC

56. Which early ruler of Magadha had murdered his father for his coronation and later assassinated by his son for the same?

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2007, 2011

- (a) Bimbisara



- (b) Ajatashatru
- (c) Udayin
- (d) Nagadashaka

57. The name of Ajatashatru's dynasty was?

- (a) Maurya **BPSC (Pre) G.S. 2011**
- (b) Haryanka
- (c) Nanda
- (d) Gupta

58. During which of the followings ruling period the authority of Magadh expanded in Maiwa region?

UP Lower (Pre) spl. 2008

- (a) Bimbisar
- (b) Ajatashatru
- (c) Udaya Bhadra
- (d) Shishunaga

59. The early capital of Magadha was:

BPSC (Pre) 2004-05,2011

- (a) Pataliputra
- (b) Vaishali
- (c) Girivraja (Rajgriha)
- (d) Champa

60. Which Magadha ruler was known as 'Aparaparashuram'?

UP UDA/LDA Spl. (Pre) 2010

- (a) Bindusar
- (b) Ajatashatru
- (c) Kalashoka
- (d) Mahapadmananda

61. Which one of the followings was not the Magadha capital?

Chhattisgarh PSC (Pre) G.S. 2010-11

- (a) Girivraja

- (b) Rajgriha
- (c) Pataliputra
- (d) Kaushambi

62. Depiction of which God is found on Yaudheya coins?

UPPCS (Mains) Spl. 1st G.S.2008

- (a) Vasudeva
- (b) Shiva
- (c) Indra
- (d) Kartikeya

63. By whom the first republic of the world 'Vaishali' was established?

BPSC (Pre) 2007-08

- (a) Maurya
- (b) Nanda
- (c) Gupta
- (d) Licchavi

64. Inscriptional evidences reveal that a canal was excavated on the order of Nanda King, in:

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 1999

- (a) Anga
- (b) Tuga
- (c) Kalinga
- (d) Magadha

65. Kalinga ruler Kharvela was associated with which dynasty?

UPPCS (Mains) G.S.1st paper 2015

- (a) Chedi
- (b) Kadamba
- (c) Haryanka
- (d) Kalinga

66. The fable of Udayan-Vasavadutta is associated with:

UP Lower (Pre) spl.2008

- (a) Ujjain



- (b) Mathura
- (c) Mahismati
- (d) Kaushambi

67. In Mahabharata by what name were the Kuninda-kings known?

Uttarakhand PCS (Pre) G.S.2016

- (a) Sarvasrestha
- (b) Adhyam
- (c) Dwij Srestha
- (d) Dwij

68. Who was the founder of the Nanda Dynasty in Magadha?

Uttarakhand PCS (Pre) G.S.2016

- (a) Mahapadmananda
- (b) Dhanananda
- (c) Nandivardhan
- (d) Mahanandin

69. What is the rate of land revenue in theological epics?

BPSC (Pre) 1995

- (a) 1/3
- (b) 1/4
- (c) 1/6
- (d) 1/8

70. Jeevaka, a famous physician during Gautam Buddha period was associated with whose court?

UP UDA/LDA (Pre) 2006

- (a) Bimbisara
- (b) Chanda Pradyota
- (c) Prasenajita
- (d) Udayan

71. Who among the following is NOT one of the nine Nandas as described in Mahabodhivamsa.

UPPSC ACF Mains Paper I 2021

- (a) Govishanka
- (b) Dassaidhdhaka
- (c) Kaivārtha
- (d) Mahanandin

72. Which one of the following administrative structures in ascending order is correct?

JPSC (Pre) 2024

- (a) Dronamukha, Sthaniya, Sangerahana, Karvatika
- (b) Sthaniya, Karvatika, Dronamukha, Sangerahana
- (c) Sthaniya Dronamukha, Karvatika, Sangerahana
- (d) Sthaniya Dronamukha, Sangerahana, Karvatika

73. From where did the Iranians and Greek come?

Shkkin PSC (Pre) 2022

- (a) North west
- (b) North east
- (c) North South
- (d) None of these

74. The correct chronological order of the following foreign invasions in India is

GUJARAT PSC CIVIL PRE 2021

- (a) Shakas, Kushanas, Greeks, Parthians
- (b) Greeks, Shakas, Parthians, Kushanas
- (c) Parthians, Greeks, Kushanas, Shakas
- (d) Shakas, Kushanas, Parthians, Greeks



75. Followings were the basic causes behind the success of Alexander in India:

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2001

1. There was no central power in India at that time
2. His army was excellent
3. He got the help from anti-national rulers
4. He was a great administrator

Choose the correct answer from the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 2 is correct
- (b) 1, 2 and 3 is correct
- (c) 2, 3 and 4 is correct
- (d) All of the above

76. Which among the followings king of Magadha was contemporary to Alexander?

BPSC (Pre) 2000-01

- (a) Mahapadmananda
- (b) Dhanananda
- (c) Sukalpa
- (d) Chandragupta Maurya

77. Who among the following did not come to India with Alexander?

UPPCS (Pre) Re-Exam G.S. 2015

- (a) Nearchus
- (b) Onesicritus
- (c) Deimachus
- (d) Aristobulus

78. Consider the following statements: UPPCS (Pre) G.S 1998

Assertion (A): After two years expedition Alexander left India.

Reason (R): He was defeated by Chandragupta Maurya.

Choose the correct answer from the codes given below:

- (a) A & R both is true and R is correct explanation to A
- (b) A & R both are true but R is not correct explanation to A
- (c) A is true but R is false
- (d) A is false but R is true

79. The women of which Indian tribe or kingdom had taken up arms against Alexander, after a large number of its soldiers had been killed or wounded in the battle field?

UPPCS (Main) G.S. Ist Paper 2013

- (a) Abhisara
- (b) Blausal
- (c) Katha
- (d) Massaga

80. Who among the followings addressed our country as India?

UP UDA/LDA Spl. 2006

- (a) Greek
- (b) Persian
- (c) Arabians
- (d) Turk



81. Name that brave Indian ruler who was defeated by Alexander on the Jhelum river bank?

UP RO/ARO (M) 2013

- (a) Ambhi
- (b) Puru (Porus)
- (c) Chandragupta Maurya
- (d) Mahapadmananda

82. First Persian ruler who established his control on some part of India:

RAS/RTS (Pre) G.S. 1994-95

- (a) Cyrus
- (b) Kambhises
- (c) Darius I
- (d) Menander

83. Which Chinese general had defeated Kanishka?

Jharkhand PSC (Pre) G.S. 2003

- (a) Pan Chao
- (b) Pan yang
- (c) Se-huang-Te
- (d) To-te

84. Which among the following Indo-Greek ruler had circulated lead coins?

UPPCS Kanoongo Exam, 2014

- (a) Strato II
- (b) Strato I
- (c) Demetrious
- (d) Menander

Mahajanapadas PYQ's : (with Answers)

1. With reference to ancient India (600–322 BC), consider the following pairs:

Territorial Region	River flowing in the region
I. Asmaka	Godavari
II. Kamboja	Vipasa
III. Avanti	Mahanadi
IV. Kosala	Sarayu

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) Only three
- (d) All the four

UPSC CSE 2025

Answer: (b) Only two

Explanation:

- Pair I (Asmaka - Godavari) is correctly matched.
- Pair II (Kamboja - Vipasa) is not correctly matched.
- Pair III (Avanti - Mahanadi) is not correctly matched.
- Pair IV (Kosala - Sarayu) is correctly matched.

Thus, only two pairs are correctly matched.

2. In which one of the following regions was Dhanyakataka, which flourished as a prominent Buddhist centre under the Mahasanghikas, located?



- (a) Andhra **UPSC IAS (Pre) 2023**
 (b) Gandhara
 (c) Kalinga
 (d) Magadha

Answer: (a) Andhra

3. Between which of the following rivers was the ancient town of Takshashila located?

UPSC CSE 2006

- (a) Indus and Jhelum
 (b) Jhelum and Chenab
 (c) Chenab and Ravi
 (d) Ravi and Beas

Answer: (a) Indus and Jhelum

4. Which one among the followings was not contemporary to three others?

UPSC CSE 2005

- (a) Bimbisara
 (b) Gautam Buddha
 (c) Menander (Milind)
 (d) Prasenjit

Answer: (c) Menander (Milind)

5. With reference to the invaders in ancient India which one of the following is the correct chronological order?

UPSC CSE 2000

- (a) Greeks-Sakas-Kushans
 (b) Greeks-Kushans-Sakas
 (c) Sakas-Greeks-Kushans
 (d) Sakas-Kushans-Greeks

Answer: (a) Greeks-Sakas-Kushans

6. Which one of the following dynasties was ruling over North India at the time of Alexander's invasion?

UPSC CSE 2000

- (a) Nanda

- (b) Maurya
 (c) Sunga
 (d) Kanva

Answer: (a) Nanda

7. Which one of the following was initially the most powerful city of India in the 6th century B.C.?

UPSC CSE 1999

- (a) Gandhar
 (b) Kamboj
 (c) Kashi
 (d) Magadha

Answer: (d) Magadha

8. The Indo-Greek kingdom set up in north Afghanistan in the beginning of the second century BC was:

UPSC CSE 1999

- (a) Bactria
 (b) Scythia
 (c) Zedrasia
 (d) Aria

Answer: (a) Bactria

9. From the third century AD when the Huna invasion ended the Roman Empire, the Indian merchants relied more and more on the:

UPSC CSE 1999

- (a) African trade
 (b) West-European trade
 (c) South-East Asian trade
 (d) Middle-Eastern trade

Answer: (c) South-East Asian trade

10. The following map shows four of the sixteen Mahajanapadas that existed in ancient India. The places



marked A, B, C and D respectively
are: **UPSC 1997**

- (a) Matsya, Cedi, Kosala, Anga
- (b) Surasena, Avanti, Vatsa, Magadha
- (c) Matsya, Avanti, Vatsa, Anga
- (d) Surasena, Cedi, Kosala, Magadha

Answer: (a) Matsya, Cedi, Kosala, Anga

11. Which one of the following statements about ancient Indian Mahajanapadas is correct?

CDS I 2014

- (a) All Mahajanapadas were oligarchies where power was exercised by a group of people
- (b) All Mahajanapadas were located in Eastern India
- (c) No army was maintained by the Mahajanapadas
- (d) Buddhist and Jaina texts list sixteen Mahajanapadas

Answer: (d) Buddhist and Jaina texts list sixteen Mahajanapadas

12. From among the following Mahajanapadas identify the gana/sangha (oligarchy)

- (A) Magadha **CDS I 2022**
- (B) Vajji

- (C) Avanti
- (D) Kosala

Answer: (B) Vajji

13. Which one of the following is NOT listed as one of the sixteen mahajana-padas in the pre-Mauryan period?

CAPF 2020

- (a) Kuru
- (b) Vatsa
- (c) Gandhara
- (d) Kalinga

Answer: (d) Kalinga

14. Anguttara Nikaya is the earliest text which mentions the list of 16 Mahajanapadas. Which among the following texts also gives the list of 16 Mahajanapadas?

Manipur PSC (Pre) 2023

- (A) Kalpa Sutra
- (B) Dipavamsa
- (C) Bhagwati Sutra
- (D) Mahavastu

Options:

- (a) Only (A) and (B)
- (b) Only (C) and (D)
- (c) Only (A), (B), (C) and (D)
- (d) Only (A), (C) and (D)

Answer: (b) Only (C) and (D)

15. Match the following: Mahajanapada | King

- (a) Kashi | (i) Bimbisara
- (b) Kosal | (ii) Ashwasena
- (c) Magadha | (iii) Udayan



(d) Vatsa | (iv) Prasenjit

Options: **MH PSC (Pre) 2022**

(a) (iii) (i) (iv) (ii)

(b) (ii) (iv) (i) (iii)

(c) (i) (iii) (iv) (ii)

(d) (iv) (iii) (ii) (i)

Answer: (b) (ii) (iv) (i) (iii)

16. Match the following:

Maharashtra PSC 2022

Mahajanapada | King

A. Kashi | 1. Bimbisara

B. Kosal | 2. Ashwasena

C. Magadha | 3. Udayan

D. Vatsa | 4. Prasenjit

Options:

(a) 3 1 4 2

(b) 2 4 1 3

(c) 1 3 4 2

(d) 4 3 2 1

Answer: (b) 2 4 1 3

17. 'Mandhata' was the ancient name of which pilgrimage centre?

(a) Kamadgiri **MPPSC Pre 2022**

(b) Omkareshwar

(c) Amarkantak

(d) Maheshwar

Answer: (b) Omkareshwar

18. How many Mahajanpadas were found in the sixth century BCE India?

(a) 16 **Mizoram PSC-2021**

(b) 18

(c) 20

(d) 22

Answer: (a) 16

19. In which Jain literature the list of sixteen Mahajanpadas of sixth century B.C. is found?

UPPSC APO 2022

(a) Bhagwati Sutra

(b) Nirvavali Sutra

(c) Vaivahik Sutra

(d) Aupapatiya Sutra

Answer: (a) Bhagwati Sutra

20. Which of the following is not correctly matched?

UPPCS RO-ARO (Mains) 2016

(a) Kamboj – Rajpur

(b) Asmaka - Potali

(c) Sursen - Kaushambi

(d) Kosala - Shravasti

Answer: (c) Sursen - Kaushambi

21. The mahajanapadas were:

Mizoram PSC (Pre) 2023

(a) Ten Kingdoms

(b) Twelve Kingdoms

(c) Fifteen Kingdoms

(d) Sixteen Kingdoms

Answer: (d) Sixteen Kingdoms

22. Choose the correctly matched pairs of Mahajanapadas with respect to their capitals.

JKPSC (Pre) 2023

Mahajanapadas | Capital

A. Avanti – Ujjainī

B. Kosala - Kaushambi

C. Magadha - Vaishali

D. Gandhara - Pooneh

Options:

(a) Only one pair matched

(b) Only two pair matched

(c) Only three pairs matched



(d) All four pairs matched

Answer: (a) Only one pair matched

23. Which of the followings pairs is not correctly matched?

Uttarakhand PCS (Mains) 2010-11

- (a) Panchala - Rohilkhand Kannauj region
- (b) Gandhara - Peshawar Rawalpindi region
- (c) Chedi - Bundelakhanda
- (d) Kuru - Himachal Pradesh

Answer: (d) Kuru - Himachal Pradesh

24. Champa was the capital of which Mahajanapada?

UP RO/ARO (Mains) 2014

- (a) Magadha
- (b) Vajji
- (c) Kosala
- (d) Anga

Answer: (d) Anga

25. What was the capital of Vatsa Mahajanapada?

OPSC (OCS) Pre 2021 Paper-I

- (a) Rajghat
- (b) Kaushambi
- (c) Ujjayini
- (d) Ahichchhatra

Answer: (b) Kaushambi

26. Which of the following is not correctly matched?

UPPSC RO/ARO Main 2017

- (a) Anga – Champa
- (b) Kosal – Ahichchhatra/Ahichatra
- (c) Vatsa – Kaushambi
- (d) Matsya – Viratnagar

Answer: (b) Kosal – Ahichchhatra/Ahichatra

27. Chand-Pradyota was ruler of which ancient republic?

MPPCS (Pre) 2019

- (a) Kasi
- (b) Anga
- (c) Avanti
- (d) Vajji

Answer: (c) Avanti

28. In ancient period the Northern Telangana District, Nizamabad was included in which Maha Janapada?

TPPSC Group-II Pre-Paper-I

- (a) Anga
- (b) Kuru
- (c) Asmaka
- (d) Panchala

Answer: (c) Asmaka

29. Names of the 16 Mahajanapadas during Mahakarya period are mentioned in Buddhist epics. The names of which of the followings Janapadas were mentioned in Ashtadhyayi of Panini?

A. Magadh RAS/RTS (Pre) G.S. 2015

- B. Asmaka
- C. Kamboja
- D. Chedi
- E. Vats

Options:

- (a) D & E
- (b) C, D & E
- (c) A, C, D & E
- (d) A, B & C

Answer: (d) A, B & C



30. The names of 16 Mahajanapadas are mentioned in nearly in 600 BCE:

BPSC (Pre) 2003-04

- (a) Mahabharat
- (b) Ramayan
- (c) Anguttara Nikaya
- (d) Lalita Vistar

Answer: (c) Anguttara Nikaya

31. Which Buddhist epics provide information about 16 Mahajanapadas during 6th century BC?

UPPCS (Pre) spl. G.S. 2004

- (a) Dirghanikaya
- (b) Tripitak
- (c) Deepavansha
- (d) Anguttara Nikaya

Answer: (d) Anguttara Nikaya

32. The reference of 16 Mahajanapadas is found in which Buddhist epics?

Uttarakhand RO/ARO (Mains) G.S. 1st 2017

- (a) Anguttara Nikaya
- (b) Mahavansha
- (c) Dirghanikaya
- (d) Mahavagga

Answer: (a) Anguttara Nikaya

33. Which was not among the early republics?

- (a) Shakya
- (b) Lichchhavi
- (c) Yaudheya
- (d) All the above

Answer: (c) Yaudheya

34. Arrange the following Magadha dynasties in chronological order:

Chhattisgarh PSC (Pre) G.S.2008

1. Nanda dynasty
2. Shunga dynasty
3. Mauryan dynasty
4. Haryanka dynasty

- (a) 2, 1, 4, 3
- (b) 4, 1, 3, 2
- (c) 3, 2, 1, 4
- (d) 1, 3, 4, 2

Answer: (b) 4, 1, 3, 2

35. Match the kings of Buddha period with their respective states and choose the correct answer from the codes given below:

UP Lower (Pre) Spl. 2004, UPPCS (Pre) GS 2000

KING (Emperor) | Kingdom (States)

- A. Pradyota | 1. Magadha
- B. Udayan | 2. Vatsa
- C. Prasenjita | 3. Avanti
- D. Ajatashatru | 4. Koshala

Options:

- (a) 1 4 2 3
- (b) 2 3 4 1
- (c) 3 2 4 1
- (d) 4 1 3 2

Answer: (c) 3 2 4 1



36. The city plan of ancient Shravasti is in shape:

- (a) Circular **UPPCS (Pre) G.S.2010**
- (b) Crescentic
- (c) Triangular
- (d) Rectangular

Answer: (b) Crescentic

Source:

37. In sixth century B.C. Suiktimati was the capital of:

UPPCS (Mains) G.S.1st 2011

- (a) Panchal
- (b) Kuru
- (c) Chedi
- (d) Avanti

Answer: (c) Chedi

38. The capital of North Panchal, according to Mahabharata, was located at:

UPPCS (Mains) G.S.2006

- (a) Hasthanpur
- (b) Indranarsha
- (c) Ahichatar
- (d) Mathura

Answer: (c) Ahichatar

39. The period of 800-600 BC is associated with which age?

- (a) Brahmin age **BPSC (Pre) 1994**
- (b) Sutra period
- (c) Ramayana period
- (d) Mahabharat period

Answer: (a) Brahmin age

40. Janapada Located at the bank of Godavari river was:

- (a) Avanti **RAS/RTS (Pre) 2008**
- (b) Vatsa
- (c) Asmaka
- (d) Kamboj

Answer: (c) Asmaka

41. What was the name of Ujjain during ancient period?

- (a) Taxila **UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2009**
- (b) Avantika
- (c) Indraprastha
- (d) None of the above

Answer: (b) Avantika

42. Mathura was the capital of which of the followings during the period of 16 Mahajanapada?

Jharkhand PSC (Pre) G.S.,1st 2013

- (a) Vajji
- (b) Vatsa
- (c) Kashi
- (d) Surasena

Answer: (d) Surasena

43. Matsya Mahajanapada of 6th century B.C. was located in:

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2017

- (a) Western Uttar Pradesh
- (b) Rajasthan
- (c) Bundelkhand
- (d) Rohilkhand

Answer: (b) Rajasthan



44. Match the following:

List-I (Mahajanapada) | **List-II**
(Capital)

- A. Avanti | I. Ujjain
B. Koshala | II. Shravasti
C. Vatsa | III. Kaushambi
D. Anga | IV. Champa

Options:

- (a) I II III IV
(b) II I IV III
(c) IV III II I
(d) III IV I II

Answer: (a) I II III IV

45. Which city served as the capital of the ancient kingdom of Magadha during the early vedic period?

- (a) Rajagriha **69th BPSC (Pre) 2023**
(b) Campa
(c) Vaishali
(d) Pataliputra

Answer: (a) Rajagriha

46. In ancient times, the area to the south of the Ganga was known as

- (a) Takshashila **68th BPSC 2022**
(b) Chola
(c) Anarta
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

Answer: (e) None of the above

47. Who was the Physician of Magadh ruler Bimbisara?

67th BPSC (Re-exam) 2021

- (a) Vijayasena
(b) Jeevaka

- (c) Manu
(d) Shilabhadra
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

Answer: (b) Jeevaka

48. The first capital of Magadha was—

Mizoram PSC-2021

- (a) Pataliputra
(b) Sahensa
(c) Rajgriha
(d) Taxila

Answer: (c) Rajgriha

49. Which of the following pairs is correctly matched?

RAS/RTS (Pre) G.S. 2013

- (a) Parshvanath-Janatrika
(b) Bindusar-Shakya
(c) Skandagupta-Maurya
(d) Chettaka-Lichelhavi

Answer: (d) Chettaka-Lichelhavi

50. The remains of which ancient city have been found at the Kumrahar site?

UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 1st 2011

- (a) Vaishali
(b) Pataliputra
(c) Kapilavastu
(d) Shravasti

Answer: (b) Pataliputra

51. The founder of Pataliputra was:

- (a) Udayin **BPSC (Pre)2007-08**
(b) Ashoka
(c) Bimbisara
(d) Mahapadmananda

Answer: (a) Udayin



52. Which among the following kings had settled Pataliputra city?

- (a) Shishunaga **BPSC (Pre) 2000-01**
- (b) Bimbisara
- (c) Ajatashatru
- (d) Udayin

Answer: (d) Udayin

53. Which ruler had opted Pataliputra as his capital?

BPSC (Pre) 2003-04

- (a) Ajatashatru
- (b) Kalashoka
- (c) Udayin
- (d) Kanishka

Answer: (c) Udayin

54. Jivaka, the royal physician of Rajagriha, was said to be the son of a prostitute. Name of that prostitute was:

- (a) Salavati **MPPSC (Pre) G.S. 2009**
- (b) Ramania
- (c) Basant Sena
- (d) Amrapali

Answer: (a) Salavati

55. During which century the early Magadha Empire emerged?

BPSC(Pre) 1997-98

- (a) 4th century BC
- (b) 6th century BC
- (c) 2nd century BC
- (d) 1st century BC

Answer: (b) 6th century BC

56. Which early ruler of Magadha had murdered his father for his coronation and later assassinated by his son for the same?

UPPCS (Pre) G.S.2007,2011

- (a) Bimbisara
- (b) Ajatashatru
- (c) Udayin
- (d) Nagadashaka

Answer: (b) Ajatashatru

57. The name of Ajatashatru's dynasty was?

- (a) Maurya **BPSC (Pre) G.S. 2011**
- (b) Haryanka
- (c) Nanda
- (d) Gupta

Answer: (b) Haryanka

58. During which of the followings ruling period the authority of Magadh expanded in Maiwa region?

UP Lower (Pre) spl. 2008

- (a) Bimbisara
- (b) Ajatashatru
- (c) Udaya Bhadra
- (d) Shishunaga

Answer: (d) Shishunaga

59. The early capital of Magadha was:

BPSC (Pre) 2004-05,2011

- (a) Pataliputra
- (b) Vaishali
- (c) Girivraja (Rajagriha)
- (d) Champa

Answer: (c) Girivraja (Rajagriha)

60. Which Magadha ruler was known as 'Aparaparashuram'?

UP UDA/LDA Spl. (Pre) 2010

- (a) Bindusara
- (b) Ajatashatru



- (c) Kalashoka
- (d) Mahapadmananda

Answer: (d) Mahapadmananda

61. Which one of the followings was not the Magadha capital?

Chhattisgarh PSC (Pre) G.S. 2010-11

- (a) Girivraja
- (b) Rajgriha
- (c) Pataliputra
- (d) Kaushambi

Answer: (d) Kaushambi

62. Depiction of which God is found on Yaudheya coins?

UPPCS (Mains) Spl. 1st G.S.2008

- (a) Vasudeva
- (b) Shiva
- (c) Indra
- (d) Kartikeya

Answer: (d) Kartikeya

63. By whom the first republic of the world 'Vaishali' was established?

- (a) Maurya
- (b) Nanda
- (c) Gupta
- (d) Licchavi

Answer: (d) Licchavi

64. Inscriptional evidences reveal that a canal was excavated on the order of Nanda King, in:

- (a) Anga
- (b) Tuga
- (c) Kalinga
- (d) Magadha

Answer: (c) Kalinga

65. Kalinga ruler Kharvela was associated with which dynasty?

UPPCS (Mains) G.S.1st paper 2015

- (a) Chedi
- (b) Kadamba
- (c) Haryanka
- (d) Kalinga

Answer: (a) Chedi

66. The fable of Udayan-Vasavadutta is associated with:

UP Lower (Pre) spl.2008

- (a) Ujjain
- (b) Mathura
- (c) Mahismati
- (d) Kaushambi

Answer: (d) Kaushambi

67. In Mahabharata by what name were the Kuninda-kings known?

Uttarakhand PCS (Pre) G.S.2016

- (a) Sarvasrestha
- (b) Adhyam
- (c) Dwij Srestha
- (d) Dwij

Answer: (c) Dwij Srestha

68. Who was the founder of the Nanda Dynasty in Magadha?

Uttarakhand PCS (Pre) G.S.2016

- (a) Mahapadmananda
- (b) Dhanananda
- (c) Nandivardhan
- (d) Mahanandin

Answer: (a) Mahapadmananda

69. What is the rate of land revenue in theological epics?

- (a) 1/3
- (b) 1/4
- (c) 1/6

BPSC (Pre) 1995



(d) 1/8

Answer: (c) 1/6

70. Jeevaka, a famous physician during Gautam Buddha period was associated with whose court?

UP UDA/LDA (Pre) 2006

- (a) Bimbisar
- (b) Chanda Pradyota
- (c) Prasenajita
- (d) Udayan

Answer: (a) Bimbisar

71. Who among the following is NOT one of the nine Nandas as described in Mahabodhivamsa.

UPPSC ACF Mains Paper I 2021

- (a) Govishanka
- (b) Dassaidhaka
- (c) Kaivartha
- (d) Mahanandin

Answer: (d) Mahanandin

72. Which one of the following administrative structures in ascending order is correct?

JPSC (Pre) 2024

- (a) Dronamukha, Sthaniya, Sangerahana, Karvatika
- (b) Sthaniya, Karvatika, Dronamukha, Sangerahana
- (c) Sthaniya Dronamukah, Karvatika, Sangerahana
- (d) Sthaniya Dronamukah, Sangerahana, Karvatika

Answer: The correct ascending order is Sangerahana < Karvatika < Dronamukha < Sthaniya. Therefore, **the correct option is (c) Sthaniya**

Dronamukah, Karvatika, Sangerahana.

73. From where did the Iranians and Greek come?

Shkkin PSC (Pre) 2022

- (a) North west
- (b) North east
- (c) North South
- (d) None of these

Answer: (a) North west

74. The correct chronological order of the following foreign invasions in India is

GUJARAT PSC CIVIL PRE 2021

- (a) Shakas, Kushanas, Greeks, Parthians
- (b) Greeks, Shakas, Parthians, Kushanas
- (c) Parthians, Greeks, Kushanas, Shakas
- (d) Shakas, Kushanas, Parthians, Greeks

Answer: (b) Greeks, Shakas, Parthians, Kushanas

75. Followings were the basic causes behind the success of Alexander in India:

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2001

1. There was no central power in India at that time
2. His army was excellent
3. He got the help from anti-national rulers
4. He was a great administrator



Choose the correct answer from the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 2 is correct
- (b) 1, 2 and 3 is correct
- (c) 2, 3 and 4 is correct
- (d) All of the above

Answer: (b) 1, 2 and 3 is correct

76. Which among the followings king of Magadha was contemporary to Alexander?

BPSC (Pre) 2000-01

- (a) Mahapadmananda
- (b) Dhanananda
- (c) Sukalpa
- (d) Chandragupta Maurya

Answer: (b) Dhanananda

77. Who among the following did not come to India with Alexander?

UPPCS (Pre) Re-Exam G.S. 2015

- (a) Nearchus
- (b) Onesicritus
- (c) Deimachus
- (d) Aristobulus

Answer: (c) Deimachus

78. Consider the following statements: UPPCS (Pre) G.S 1998

Assertion (A): After two years expedition Alexander left India.

Reason (R): He was defeated by Chandragupta Maurya.

Choose the correct answer from the codes given below:

- (a) A & R both is true and R is

- correct explanation to A
- (b) A & R both are true but R is not correct explanation to A
- (c) A is true but R is false
- (d) A is false but R is true

Answer: (c) A is true but R is false

79. The women of which Indian tribe or kingdom had taken up arms against Alexander, after a large number of its soldiers had been killed or wounded in the battle field?

UPPCS (Main) G.S. 1st Paper 2013

- (a) Abhisara
- (b) Blausal
- (c) Katha
- (d) Massaga

Answer: (d) Massaga

80. Who among the followings addressed our country as India?

UP UDA/LDA Spl. 2006

- (a) Greek
- (b) Persian
- (c) Arabians
- (d) Turk

Answer: (a) Greek

81. Name that brave Indian ruler who was defeated by Alexander on the Jhelum river bank?

UP RO/ARO (M) 2013

- (a) Ambhi
- (b) Puru (Porus)
- (c) Chandragupta Maurya
- (d) Mahapadmananda

Answer: (b) Puru (Porus)



82. First Persian ruler who established his control on some part of India:

RAS/RTS (Pre) G.S. 1994-95

- (a) Cyrus
- (b) Kambhises
- (c) Darius I
- (d) Menander

Answer: (c) Darius I

83. Which Chinese general had defeated Kanishka?

Jharkhand PSC (Pre) G.S. 2003

- (a) Pan Chao

- (b) Pan yang
- (c) Se-huang-Te
- (d) To-te

Answer: (a) Pan Chao

84. Which among the following Indo-Greek ruler had circulated lead coins?

UPPCS Kanoongo Exam, 2014

- (a) Strato II
- (b) Strato I
- (c) Demetrious
- (d) Menander

Answer: (a) Strato II

